Systematic Biology

User Manual

Journal article LaTeX authoring template

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User Manual

Journal article LaTeX authoring template

Prepared by Straive TeX Support

1. Introduction

This authoring template helps you prepare journal articles in LaTeX that conform to technical requirements. The template is stylistically neutral. We recommend avoiding the introduction of any unnecessary formatting as non-standard packages and macros are frequent causes of error. Wherever possible please do not add further packages to the template. Adhering to these guidelines will ease the production process of any accepted manuscript and help avoid misinterpretation of your LaTeX code.

This documentation is not intended to give an introduction to LaTeX. For questions concerning TeX systems/installations or the LaTeX mark-up language in general, please visit http://tug.ctan.org/ or any other TeX user group worldwide. The essential reference for LaTeX is Mittelbach F., Goossens M. *(2004) The LaTeX Companion. 2nd edn.*, but there are many other good books about LaTeX.

2. How to prepare your article

Ensure that you have LaTeX2e version installed on your computer. You are provided with a class file "sysbio.cls" and must keep this class file in the same directory as your manuscript files.

2.1 Options

We have supplied a LaTeX template file—"sample.tex". The below options can be enabled based on the article category of your paper.

`\documentclass{sysbio}` Regular Manuscripts

`\documentclass[POV]{sysbio}` Enable POC option for ``Points of View''

`\documentclass[SSE]{sysbio}` Enable SSE option for ``Software for Systematics and Evolution''

The sample file contains the lines for calling class files, preamble area, and the start/end of document where major elements required for an article are placed. Explanatory comments are included for each element. You can add your actual manuscript content in place of these sample

elements. The standard structure of each element for an article is explained in detail in the following sections.

To use the sysbio authoring template, place all the files (sysbio.cls, sysbio.bst, sample.tex, references.bib) in your working directory, edit the file "sample.tex" and the "references.bib" file in your preferred text editor, and run LaTeX as usual.

The resulting layout is optimized for peer review and will not be identical to the layout of a final article. You are not responsible for any final page layout and the use of fine-tuning commands like `\break`, `\pagebreak`, `\vspace`, `\bigskip`, `\clearpage`, *etc*. are not encouraged. Please use semantic mark-up as far as possible and avoid additional formatting commands.

3. Package features and some important settings

3.1. Language

English is the default language used for typesetting rules.

3.2. Fonts

Please refrain from using custom fonts.

Text fonts: Unlike the final published version, the authoring template uses non-commercial fonts: Computer Modern. These fonts are free version of the PostScript standard fonts and are supplied as part of all standard TeX distributions.

Math fonts: The standard Computer Modern math fonts are used.

4. Preamble

The preamble part comes between the document class line — `\documentclass{...}` —and the beginning of your document —`\begin{document}`. Use this preamble area to include additional packages.

5. Major structures/elements

Article contents are divided into two main elements—front matter and main matter. The elements before `\maketitle` tag are considered as front matter elements and the elements placed after `\maketitle` tag are main matter elements.

Front matter	Main matter	Back matter
\title{. . .}	\section{. . .}	
\author{. . .}	\subsection{. . .}	
\address{...}	\subsubsection{. . .}	\appendix
\corresp{. . .} \email{. . .}	\begin{table}. . .\end{table} \begin{table*}. . .\end{table*}	\begin{thebibliography}{} ... \end{thebibliography}
\abstract{. . .}	\begin{figure}. . .\end{figure} \begin{figure*}. . .\end{figure*}	
\keywords{. . .}	\begin{itemize}. . .\end{itemize}	
\maketitle	\begin{enumerate} \end{enumerate}	
	\begin{description}. . . \end{description}	
	\begin{equation}. .\end{equation}	
	\begin{align}...\end{align}	

The above listed tags are pre-defined in the class file "sysbio.cls". If necessary, you can define your own customized tags as per your preference.

6. Front matter elements

The tagging details of article opener elements are as follows:

1. `\title{<article-title>}`
2. `\author[<affil-num>]{<author-name>}` —to be used for all other authors.

   `\author [<affil-num>,\ast]{<author-name>}`— to be used for the corresponding author who is nominated as being responsible for the manuscript as it moves through the entire publication process.

3. `\address[<sequence>]{<address-details>}`—affiliation/address details are provided inside this tag. In case of multiple addresses, just provide sequential Arabic numerals in the optional argument of this tag. This number is used to denote the affiliation for the respective authors. In case of single author/address, this optional argument can be ignored. For example:

```
\author{...}
\address{...}
```

4. `\address[<sequence>]{<address-details>}`—This tag is to represent author's corresponding address.

`\maketitle`—This tag is mandatory to print the front matter elements in the output.

7. Main matter elements

7.1. Section headings

The template allows three levels of headings in different styles:

```
\section{<First level heading>}
\subsection{<Second level heading>}
\subsubsection{<Third level heading>}
```

7.2. Mathematical formulae

The "amsmath" package provides various features for displayed equations and other mathematical constructs and you are strongly encouraged to use the mark-ups provided by this package. Do not use manual skips to align an equation.

7.3. Figures and Tables

The standard interface for graphic inclusion is the `\includegraphics` command provided by the graphicx package. **Do not place your image files in subfolders, as the manuscript submission system will be unable to find them.** Include them on the same level as your LaTeX document. Also make sure that each figure is from a single input image file. Avoid using subfigures. LaTeX compiler accepts only .eps image file format. If you have .ps image file format, rename them to .eps images.

The format used for numbered "figures" and "tables" is similar to LaTeX basic format:

```
\begin{figure}[t]
\centering
\includegraphics{<image-file-name>}
\caption{<Caption text>}\label{...}
\end{figure}
```

The format for a table is as follows:

```
\begin{table}[<float-position>]
\tblcaption{...\label{<table-label>}}{%
\begin{tabular}{<column-alignment-preamble>}
\toprule
...  & ... & ... & ... \\
\midrule
... & ... & ... & ...\footnotemark[1] \\
... & ... & ... & ... \\
... & ... & ... & ...\footnotemark[2] \\
\botrule
\end{tabular}}{<Table footnote text>}\end{table}
```

To span a figure/table across two column, please use \begin{figure*}...\end{figure*} and \begin{table*}...\end{table*} respectively. Please refer sample.tex for more details.

7.4. Lists

The default list commands available in LaTeX can be used to set different types of lists:

1. **numbered:** `\begin{enumerate}...\end{enumerate}`

2. **unnumbered:** `\begin{description}...\end{description}`

3. **bulleted list:** `\begin{itemize}...\end{itemize}`

7.5. Cross references

A feature of LaTeX is the ability to automatically insert hypertext links within a document:

- the `\label{...}` command is used to identify an object (i.e. an equation, figure, table). This identifier is used in the `\ref{...}` command for cross-referencing.

- the `\ref{...}` command inserts a clickable link to an object as defined by it's label

7.6. Citations

The bibliography styles provided in the template package support author-year and numbered citations. The citation option used by default is the most common one for the bibliography style.

`\citep{...}` should be used for a parenthetical citation. For e.g. (Jones et al. 1990)

`\cite{...}` should be used for textual citation. For e.g. Jones et al. (1990)

Please refer to the "natbib" package documentation for full details and citation commands including optional arguments to describe chapters.

8. Back matter elements

8.1. Appendices

This section start with `\appendix` command. All the other commands used to set section heads, tables, and figures inside this section remain the same as main body text.

8.2. References

BibTeX is the preferred format for references. BibTeX automates most of the work involved in references for articles. Using BibTeX options, both citations and references can be automatically updated to the preferred reference style. BibTeX works with two parts of the references: *content* and *style*. The *content* is stored separately in a plain text database file called .bib. The *style* and presentation of the .bib file content are processed with the help of BibTeX program using a style file called .bst (bibliography style file). You are requested to use the references.bib file provided as a base for preparing your own .bib file.

Then include your .bib file at the end of your document as shown below:

```
\bibliography{<bib-file-without-extension>}
```

To generate a .bbl file run LaTeX on your manuscript file once, followed by BibTeX, and then run LaTeX twice, to ensure that citations are set correctly.

The resulting bibliography is ready for typesetting with all formatting tags rendered according to the chosen reference style. For more details, please visit http://www.bibtex.org.

9. Author support

You can write to LaTeXSupport@straive.com for any assistance during your manuscript preparation.

10. SYSBIO – File details

User Manual	user-manual.pdf	Provides details on SYSBIO Authoring Template and its usage
Class file	sysbio.cls	SYSBIO authoring template class file
Sample LaTeX files	sample.tex	Sample TeX file
Sample PDF file	sample.pdf	PDF output of sample.tex
.bst files	sysbio.bst	.bst file to be used for reference style
.eps file	empty.eps	Dummy image for Placement purpose
.bib file	references.bib	Sample .bib file

11. Change History

Version No.	Revision Date	Revision Note
Version 1.0	August 2024	Original release date.
Version 1.1	October 2024	Modified the template to a two-column format, ensuring the width of both columns aligns closely with the original specifications for font, equations, and other elements, so that the overall appearance resembles the original layout